

OCBC Bank

First take: NIM disappoints, guidance maintained across metrics

Our First Take: OCBC reported 1Q25 net income of S\$1,883mn, down 5% y/y, up 12% q/q and in line with estimates. Details indicate weaker trends, particularly on NIM, which saw sharp 11bps q/q contraction (UOB flat, DBS -3bps q/q). Lower benchmark rates weighed on loan yields, which further led to NII declining 4% q/q. OCBC had the highest NIM expansion in H4L (almost 80bps), and is giving up most as SORA comes off. On the other hand, non-II was a source of strength, with WM driving 6% q/q improvement in fees, and trading delivering q/q improvement. Costs were managed slightly better than our expectations. Asset quality was stable with lower new NPA formation q/q, and higher provisions mainly for non-impaired assets (potentially increasing buffers, similar to peers). Higher unrealized gains likely drove equity up 3% q/q, with CET1 20bps higher q/q on a fully phased-in basis. Management has maintained 2025 targets across metrics, including NIM in the region of 2%, mid-single digit loan growth, low 40s CIR, and 20-25bps credit costs. The bank also reiterated its 60% total dividend payout, and S\$2.5bn capital return (dividends and buyback).

On balance, we see this result as relatively weak, led by the NIM disappointment as part of the strength (non-II) was already expected in the quarter following results from peers and key subsidiaries. DBS remains our preferred pick among Singapore banks.

Key Positives

Non-II was robust across fees and trading, with major subsidiaries also delivering in the quarter. Costs were well-managed, with CIR moving below 40%.

Key Negatives/Question Marks

NIM declined 11bps q/q to 2.04%, largely driven by lower loan yields, though OCBC continued to deploy liquidity to high-quality assets.

Likely Changes to Consensus

We expect negative revisions post 1Q.

Expected Stock Reaction

NA

Conference Call Details

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Not Rated

OCBC.SI, OCBC.SP

Price (08 May 25): S\$16.16

**FIRST
TAKE**



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The bank is hosting a briefing at 9am SGT. Let us know if you'd like to register.

Table 1: OCBC: 1Q25 Earnings Review

P&L (\$mn)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25A	1Q25E	YoY	QoQ	JPMe
Net Interest Income	2,437	2,430	2,433	2,455	2,345	2,415	-4%	-4%	-3%
Non-Interest Income	1,189	1,199	1,369	961	1,310	1,232	10%	36%	6%
Net Fee Income	479	466	508	517	546	533	14%	6%	3%
Operating Revenue	3,626	3,629	3,802	3,416	3,655	3,647	1%	7%	0%
Operating Costs	(1,346)	(1,373)	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,455)	5%	-9%	-3%
PPOP	2,280	2,256	2,339	1,856	2,240	2,192	-2%	21%	2%
Provisions	(194)	(166)	(176)	(213)	(212)	(192)	9%	0%	10%
Other Income	255	243	251	245	274	257	7%	12%	7%
Amortisation, tax and NCI	(359)	(389)	(440)	(201)	(419)	(375)	17%	108%	12%
Core Attributable Profit	1,982	1,944	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,882	-5%	12%	0%
DPS (\$)	-	0.44	-	0.57	-	-	NA	-100%	NA
Common Equity	55,170	55,219	55,932	57,616	59,190	56,666	7%	3%	4%
Gross Loans	300,915	303,983	305,417	319,166	322,000	322,490	7%	1%	0%
Net Loans	296,932	299,980	301,285	315,096	317,885	318,363	7%	1%	0%
Deposits	369,841	369,295	369,280	390,687	402,732	392,551	9%	3%	3%
NPL	3,010	2,817	2,745	2,827	2,898	2,867	-4%	3%	1%
LLR	3,983	4,003	4,132	4,070	4,115	4,127	3%	1%	0%
							Change in bps		
NIM	2.27%	2.20%	2.18%	2.15%	2.04%	2.12%	(23)	(11)	(8)
CIR	37.1%	37.8%	38.5%	45.7%	38.7%	39.9%	159	(695)	(118)
LDR	81.4%	82.3%	82.7%	81.7%	80.0%	82.2%	(141)	(174)	(220)
CASA Ratio	47.4%	47.8%	48.4%	48.8%	48.9%	48.2%	150	7	65
Credit Costs (reported)	16	15	22	21	24	22	8	3	2
NPL Ratio	1.00%	0.93%	0.90%	0.89%	0.90%	0.89%	(10)	1	1
NPA coverage	146%	155%	164%	159%	162%	159%	1,600	300	300
CET1 (Fully phased-in)	16.2%	15.5%	15.6%	15.3%	15.5%	15.0%	(66)	18	55
CET1 (Transitory)	16.2%	15.5%	17.2%	17.1%	17.6%	16.6%	144	51	96

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends. Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



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